

KEEPING THE SPIRITS HIGH

For HUL, a motivated workforce leads to multiple advantages and the consumer giant is banking on that to bolster growth

BY KRISHNA GOPALAN

PHOTOS BY HARDIK CHHABRA

THE FIRST THING that a chuffed Anuradha Razdan tells you is that she has completed 25 years at FMCG major Hindustan Unilever Ltd (HUL). She passed out from the prestigious XLRI in Jamshedpur in 1999 and joined HUL as a management trainee. She has been there since. And to be fair to Razdan, a steady career path has helped her a great deal. In these years, she has grown from a management trainee to Executive Director (HR) and CHRO, HUL & Unilever South Asia. And since we met her in late April, it has been announced that

she would now move to a global role as Unilever's Chief Reward & Organisation Development Officer.

"The enduring parts of our culture have not changed and one of that is to be boringly consistent," she says. HUL is a very large organisation (it ended FY24 with a revenue of ₹62,707 crore and a net profit of ₹10,282 crore), and has an enviable set of brands under its umbrella. According to Razdan, HUL is an employer of choice at the Top 20 B-school campuses in India. "People want to be a part of a winning business, and we're one," she says proudly.

Moving a monolith is not easy but HUL, time and again, has shown how it can be done. Razdan speaks of innovation with its marketing models, supply chain, and distribution. "We set the trend and constantly create a leadership factory," she explains. It cannot be forgotten that talent today is very different from, say, a decade ago and job options have increased quite

dramatically, forcing any organisation to up its game all the time. "For us the process of talent attraction is serious business, and we spend a lot of time on that. If we get it right there, a lot of things fall into place."

In the last decade or so, the FMCG industry has undergone significant disruptions, largely propelled by technology. Traditional consumer purchasing behaviours, like in-store shopping, have shifted towards a situation where both the offline purchase and online ordering can coexist together. In the face of such change, Razdan says that what remains unchanged is HUL's dedication to skill-building, despite the unprecedented business transformation underway.

"Just look at the spectrum that covers general trade, modern trade, and e-commerce. The opportunity is to make the organisation future-ready, and we will do that by upskilling our people

4 HUL TOP ATTRIBUTES

- FAIR AND OBJECTIVE PROCESSES AND POLICIES
- GROWTH AND LEARNING OPPORTUNITIES
- JOB SECURITY AND STABILITY
- ◀ FLEXIBILITY FOCUSED Anuradha Razdan, ED (HR) and CHRO, HUL & Unilever South Asia